

User Interaction and Usability of Digital Products

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Human-Computer Interaction

CLASS-15

Interaction Design

User Interaction and UI Patterns...

Cognition & User Behaviour Pattern Related to UI/UX Design...

Cognition & User Behaviour Pattern Related to UI/UX Design

Following are a few of the most common behaviours that people demonstrate as they relate to product interaction and design. A User Interaction that supports these patterns will assist the users in achieving their goals effectively and quickly.

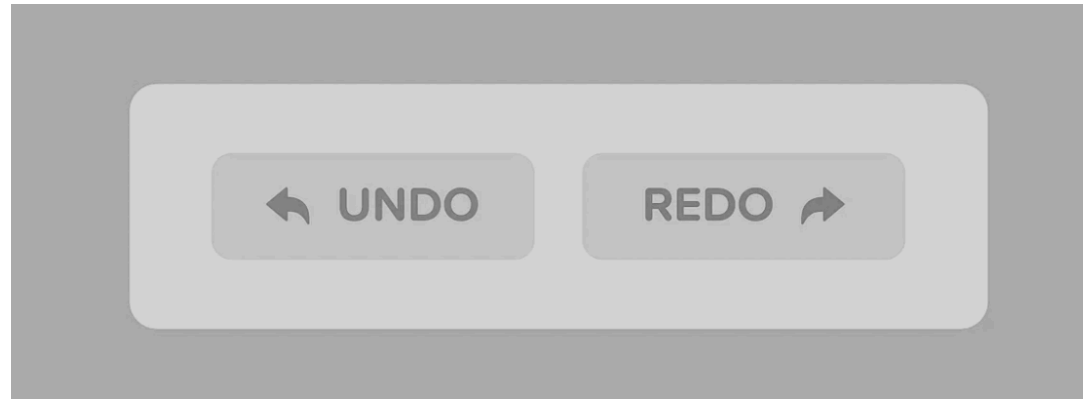
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Self Exploration

Unlike in the real world, interfaces make it easy for users to mend their mistakes. If you're at the office and spill coffee on your skirt, then you're kind of screwed — you can't CTRL + Z that. Our interface designs, in contrast, should encourage users to explore the different options available and then allow them to get back where they started or undo any actions easily.

Examples:

- Back buttons making it easy to get back where I started
- Trying photo filters but making it easy to undo if I don't like the result
- Saving history
- Undo buttons for documents



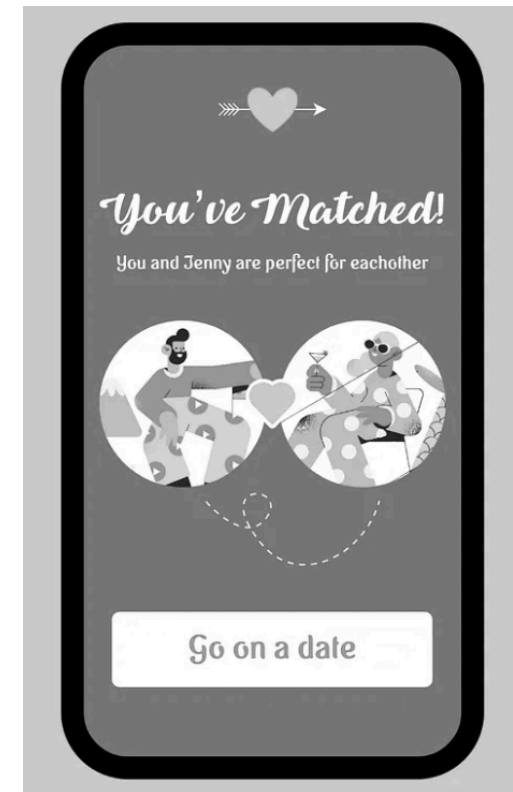
Instant Gratification

In our fast-moving digital world, everything is getting that much quicker and easier. Hungry? Need a ride? Uber is minutes away. Want a date? You could be matched with a potential date in a matter of seconds on dating apps.

If our product isn't providing an instant hit of dopamine, then it's at risk of being disrupted by a competitor's product that is. Consider in your design how you can give your users a feeling of satisfaction or achievement in the experience.

Examples:

- Getting a match on a dating app
- A blast of Confetti when you complete a habit
- Calling an Uber and immediately having one on the way
- Hitting the snooze button



Satisficing

Word *Satisficing* is the sum of satisfying and sufficing. This means that people will accept the "good enough" instead of "best", if it does not takes time and effort.

For instance, an user opens a yoga app for the first time and he needs to find a button for videos. He'll likely scan the interface and go for the one that he thinks it "might be the video one". The user won't work hard to find the right button and there's a good chance that he'll leave your application if he doesn't find it (or he will try wrong buttons until he finds the right one).

Make the most important information simple for your user to grasp at a glance. If you're relying on your users to read large blocks of text to understand how your product can benefit them, then you're allowing the majority of potential users to fall through the cracks.

Key points:

- Make obvious options that are safe for the user to select
- An interface should be easily scannable
- Users will look for the first option that might work

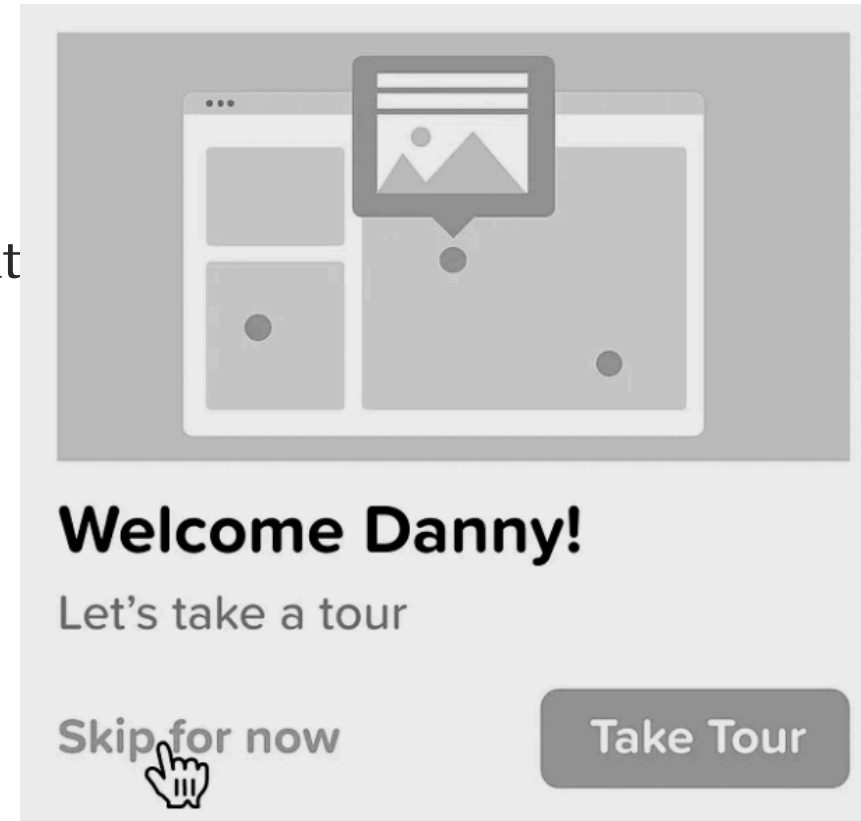
Deferred Choices

As UX designers, we should be considering where we can slim the fat wherever necessary. Don't ask for unnecessary information, but more importantly, allow information to be entered later or make it optional.

Anything that isn't 100% necessary should be skippable.

Key points:

- Don't have too many steps
- Allow users to 'skip'
- Separate important questions from the ones that are less important
- Allow users to add, change, or edit things later



Habituation

“When you use an interface repeatedly, some frequent physical actions become reflexive: pressing Ctrl-S to save a document, clicking the Back button to leave a web page, pressing Return to close a modal dialog box, using gestures to show and hide windows — even pressing a car’s brake pedal. The user no longer needs to think consciously about these actions. They’ve become habitual.”

If there is an industry-standard for interaction or UI, then it’s best to follow these conventions to be safe — redesigning existing patterns is generally more confusing than useful. Save your creativity for other aspects of the product.

Examples:

- CTRL + S, CTRL + Z
- Swiping left or right to go to the next or previous screen
- Pressing X to exit a dialog
- Swiping down to refresh on mobile



Spatial Memory

“When people manipulate objects and documents, they often find them again later by remembering where they are, not what they’re named.”

“Spatial memory explains why it’s good to provide user-arranged areas for sorting documents and objects, such as the aforementioned desktop. When people arrange things themselves, they’re likely to remember where they put them.”

Think about your application as though it’s a physical space. People will be arranging things in a way that they see fit, not how your algorithm thinks they should be. Make it easy for your users to re-arrange things and bookmark or save items for later.

Examples:

Grouping apps into folders

Snapchat placing different screens with a swipe left, right, up, or down

Arranging programs on a desktop

Sorting cards in Apple wallet



Prospective Memory

“I’m putting this here to remind myself to deal with it later.”

“We arrange in prospective memory when we plan to do something in the future, and we arrange some way of reminding ourselves to do it. For example, if you need to bring a book to work the next day, the night before, you might put it on a table beside the front door. If you need to respond to someone’s email later, you might leave that email on your screen as a physical reminder.”

Prospective memory doesn’t appear too frequently in interfaces, but it’s an important pattern to recognise and design for. The infrastructure for prospective memory is what’s most important. Allowing users to save drafts, be reminded of something later, or placing un-finished tasks in an easy to find spot will assist the user when they return to the task.

Examples:

- Leaving windows open as a reminder that something needs to be completed
- Starring or marking an email as unread
- Bookmarking websites to view later
- Highlighting text in a document as a reminder to revise it later



Streamlined Limitation

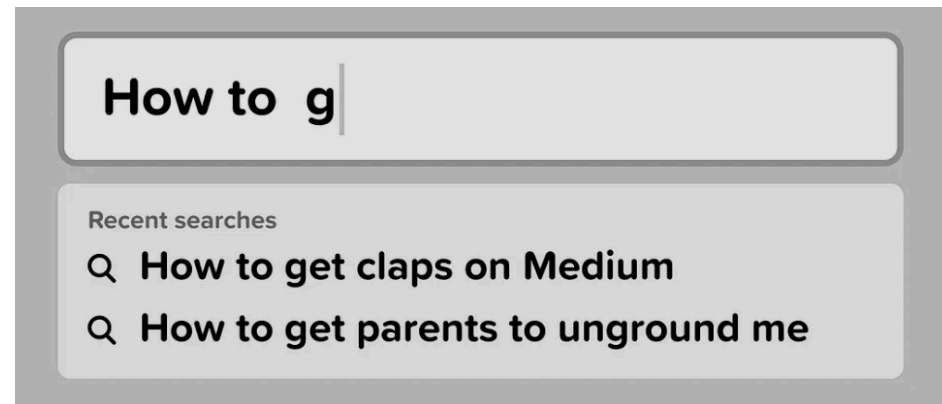
“I have to repeat this how many times?”

“In many kinds of applications, users sometimes find themselves needing to perform the same operation over and over again. The easier it is for them, the better. If you can help reduce the operation down to one keystroke or click per repetition — or better, just a few keystrokes or clicks for all repetitions — you will spare users much tedium.”

If your users are continuously repeating the same command or action — make a shortcut or workflow for it to make their life easier.

Examples:

- Autofill when you start typing something
- Google Chrome auto-completing the query “yo” with “www.youtube.com”
- Automating routine processes in Slack with workflow builder
- “Delete All” or “Select All”



Microbreaks

“I’m waiting for the train. Let me do something useful for two minutes.”

“People often find themselves with a few minutes of downtime. They might need a mental break while working; they might be in line at a store or sitting in a traffic jam. They might be bored or impatient. They want to do something constructive or entertaining to pass the time, knowing they won’t have enough time to get deep into an online activity.”

Interface should encourage users to use it in the spare 2 minutes they have on the elevator. Making it easy to learn something quickly, be entertained, or find the information they need. This goes back to instant gratification — if a user is confident that your application will give them a quick moment of delight, then they’ll come back again and again.

Examples:

- Scrolling through Instagram
- Reading news
- Playing a game
- Responding to messages
- Checking email

Social Proofs and Collaboration

“What did everyone else say about this?”

“People are social. As strong as our opinions might sometimes be, we tend to be influenced by what our peers say or do. And we are powerfully attuned to seeking approval from others and belonging to a group. We maintain social media identities. We contribute to groups and people we care about.”

Social proof can make your product more compelling. It doesn't necessarily need to include the user's friends, though it can. Displaying items based on popularity will make your users feel less alone in their decision making. If others have chosen to do something and were pleased with their choice, then there's a good chance that it's a sensible option.

Examples:

- Reviews on Amazon, Airbnb, Yelp, etc.
- Likes, reactions, shares, retweets, followers, number of friends, a blue checkmark, views etc.
- Advice or recommended products from friends
- “48 of your friends like this page”

Activity

7,807 followers

Sandip Poddar commented on a post • 2d

A well rounded panelkeep.inspiring in today's so called funding winter.

  25

2 comments

Sandip Poddar commented on a post • 2w

Congratulations TEZone more feather to the cap

   104

21 comments

Changed in Midstream

Basically, you need to give opportunity for the user to change his mind during a task. It's important to make it easy for someone to start a task, stop in the middle and come back to it later to continue from where he left off.

Example: an online store that keep your items on its cart even after a long time of inactivity or when you close the website.

